



Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Mr. Rawson • GCSE Physics

Study Techniques

Next test: Monday 5 October, Period 6

Every one of you can do very well on a physics test. When there is a gap between what a student can do and the mark they get, it nearly always comes down to how they studied. The best way to study is to practise in conditions that look like the test, so that on the day the test feels familiar.

Write everything out on paper

Do your studying with a pencil in your hand, in a notebook kept just for physics. Set out every page so that you can **find the worksheet and the question again later**.

1. Write the name of the worksheet or topic at the top of the page, with the date.
2. Write the number of each question in the left-hand margin.
3. Write out every step, starting with the original formula. The question itself can stay on the worksheet, as long as the heading and the number lead you back to it.
4. Put a **star** next to any question you got wrong, so you know which topics to review later.

When you finish, the paper is a record of exactly what you did and how much you studied, and anything you were unsure about is written down, ready to ask about in class.

Set up like a test

- Sit at a desk, in a quiet room, with everything you need in front of you: notebook, pencil, calculator, ruler and the equation sheet.
- Switch your phone off and leave it in another room for the whole session.

Work the problems yourself

- Answer each question on your own, all the way to a final answer, before you open the mark scheme.
- Mark it against the scheme in a different colour, then do the questions you dropped marks on again, from a blank page, a day or two later.
- Keep going until you can do every type of question with the mark scheme closed.

If you plan to study with AI ...

AI can be a good study partner when you use it well. Reading an AI's answers gives you a feeling of understanding that fades quickly, and the understanding that lasts into a test comes from doing the problem yourself.

- Work through a problem with the AI until every step makes sense.
- Ask it for a new problem of the same kind, close the AI, and solve it on paper.
- If you can do it on your own, you know it. If you get stuck, that is the part you still need to learn, so go back to the AI for that step and then try another problem without it.
- Keep repeating the cycle. It shows you clearly what you truly know, and what you are still leaning on the AI for.

Plan your study time

- Study in focused blocks of 25–30 minutes, then take a five-minute break away from the desk.
- Spread several short sessions across the week, so the night before the test is a light review.
- Put your sessions in your planner now, and show this sheet at home or to your houseparent so they can help you keep to it.
- The night before the test, pack your kit (pencil, ruler and calculator) and get a full night's sleep.